



Hate Crimes

against minorities in India

April - June 2024



Quarterly Review by

**Justice and Empowerment
of Minorities**

A Jamiat Ulama-i-Hind Initiative



Executive Summary

The second quarter of 2024 has witnessed a significant and concerning rise in hate crimes against minorities in India. During this period, a total of 288 cases were thoroughly recorded and verified, reflecting an alarming trend that necessitates immediate attention and intervention. This comprehensive report, prepared by the Justice and Empowerment of Minorities (JEM), aims to provide a detailed analysis of the nature, distribution, and implications of these incidents. The report draws on data sourced from verified mainstream media, social media reports, and extensive on-the-ground investigations to ensure accuracy and reliability.

Introduction

The Justice and Empowerment of Minorities (JEM) is committed to rigorously documenting and addressing hate crimes targeting minority communities in India. This quarterly report provides an extensive analysis of the period from April to June 2024, highlighting a notable escalation in the occurrence and intensity of such incidents. The report aims to offer a thorough and empirical understanding of the current state of hate crimes in India. By deliberately detailing these developments, our objective is to facilitate evidence-based decision making and to advocate for targeted interventions aimed at effectively addressing this critical societal challenges.



During April, May and June 2024, a total of

288 cases

were thoroughly recorded and verified,



Methodology

adopted in preparing
this report

Data Collection



Verification



Categorization



Analysis



Report



✓ Data Collection & Verification

Data were systematically gathered from a diverse range of secondary sources, including reputable news outlets, social media platforms, and video evidence.

Each reported incident underwent a rigorous verification process. This process involved cross-referencing information from multiple sources to establish the credibility and authenticity of each incident.

The verification process included identifying inconsistencies, corroborating witness accounts, and evaluating the reliability of the sources. This ensured that only verified and credible information was included in the report, filtering out any unverified or dubious claims.

✓ Categorization

Incidents were methodically categorized into distinct types, such as Physical Assaults, Hate Speech, and Damage to Religious Property, Police Misconduct, and other Forms of Violence. This systematic classification facilitated targeted analysis and enabled the identification of patterns and trends within the data.

✓ Analysis Tools

An advanced Excel dashboard was utilized for data compilation and analytical modeling. This sophisticated tool allowed us for the categorization of incidents, trend analysis, and the generation of visual representations. These visual tools supported comprehensive insights and enhanced the overall understanding of the data.

Overview of Hate Crimes

In the second quarter of 2024, we tracked a total of 288 hate crime incidents. These incidents were carefully recorded and looked at in detail to understand their nature and impact. By sorting these cases into categories like violence, hate speech, and property damage, we get a clearer picture of how widespread and varied these crimes are. This detailed breakdown helps us see the big picture of the challenges faced by minority communities and is important for figuring out how to tackle these issues effectively.

Total 288 Incidents

of Hate Crimes on

Muslims

Christians

Sikhs

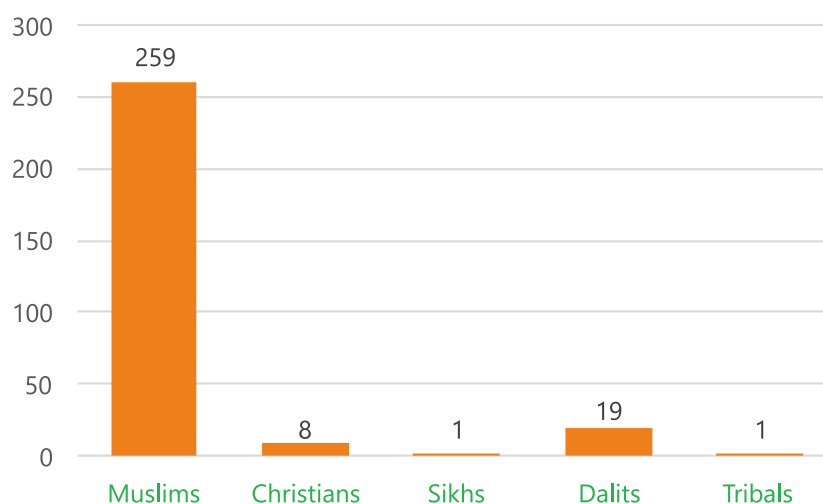
Dalits and

Tribals



Incident Distribution

by Minority Group



Analysis:

The data shows that Muslims are the most frequently targeted minority group, with Dalits, Christians, Tribal communities, and Sikhs also being affected. The pattern reflects a significant level of religious intolerance and discrimination among the society. This disproportionate targeting of Muslims, in particular, highlights the severe impact of biasness and prejudice against specific community. The targeting of these other groups further underscores the widespread nature of intolerance, impacting various segments of society. This pattern reveals deeper, systemic issues that need to be addressed to combat discrimination and promote equality for all communities.

The data shows that Muslims are the most frequently targeted group, with 259 incidents reported, making up 89.3% of the total. Muslim

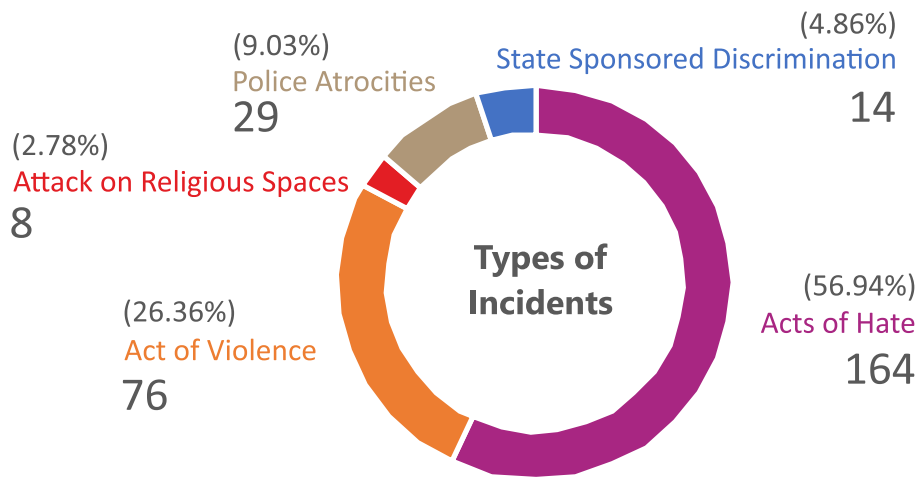
communities were targeted in nearly half of the recorded incidents, reflecting deep-rooted religious biases and potential systemic discrimination. The targeting of Muslims also indicates a systematic pattern of religious intolerance, worsened by communal ideologies and socio-political factors.

Dalit's, though often targeted for caste-based reasons, faced significant incidents suggesting a dual discrimination based on caste. Dalit's have been affected by 19 incidents, accounting for 6.60% of the total.

Christians have experienced 8 incidents, which is 2.78% of the total. Sikhs and Tribal's are among the least targeted, with only 1 incident each, representing 0.35% of the total.

Incident Distribution

by types of Incidents



Analysis:

Acts of Hate and Violence constitutes the majority of the incidents, highlighting the aggressiveness nature of these crimes. Police Atrocities and State Sponsored Discrimination also significantly contributes to the overall threat faced by the minorities.

Acts of Hate, including verbal abuse and hate speech, accounted for 164 incidents (56.94%), underscoring the widespread prevalence of intolerance and discriminatory rhetoric.

Act of Violence, with 76 incidents (26.39%), indicate a significant level of direct, violent confrontations against minority individuals.

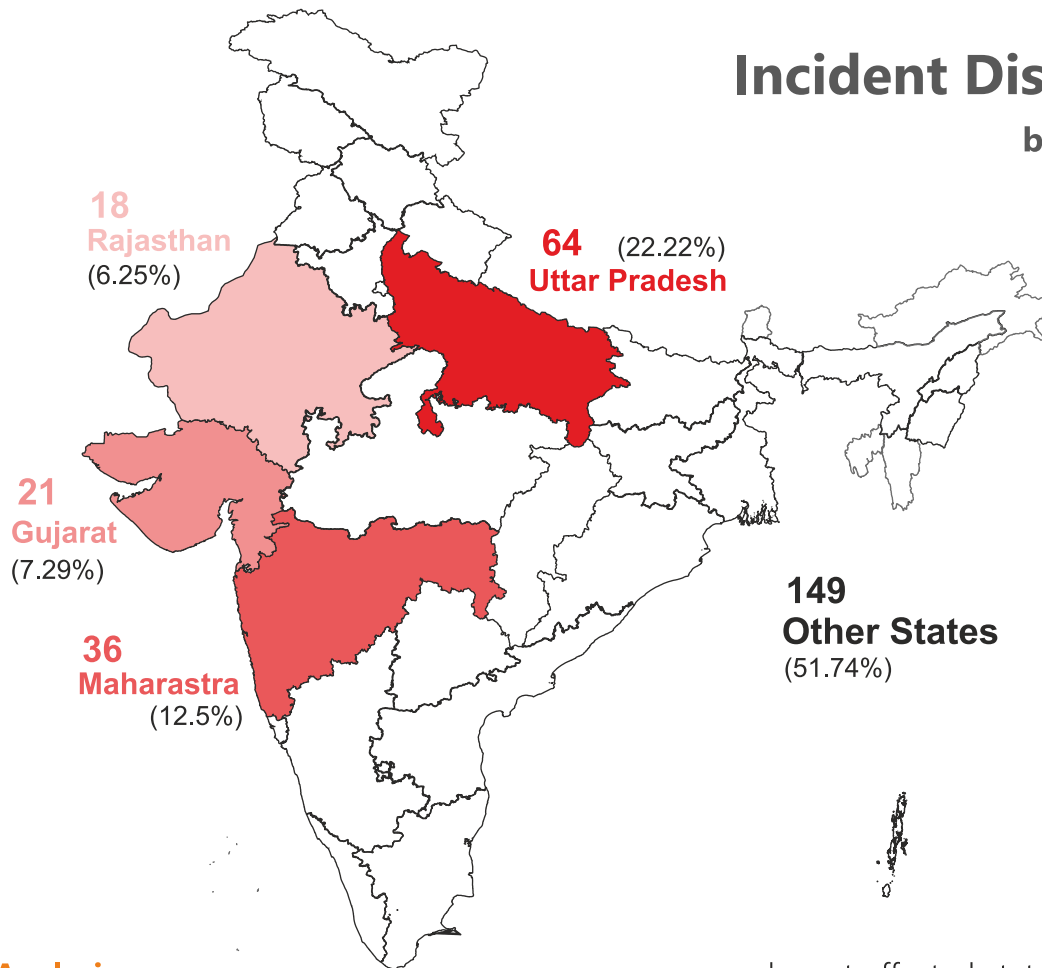
Attack on Religious Spaces, involving 8 incidents (2.78%), signifies targeted attacks on the cultural and religious symbols of minority communities.

Police Atrocities cases highlight systemic issues within law enforcement regarding bias and improper handling of minority-related incidents, totaling 26 incidents (9.03%).

State-sponsored discrimination cases, totaling 14 incidents (4.86%), involve discriminatory actions or policies endorsed by a government or state authorities.

Incident Distribution

by Indian States



Analysis:

Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra, Gujarat, and Rajasthan have the highest number of recorded incidents. This concentration of incidents in these states points that there may be some specific regional factors. These factors could include local political dynamics, social tensions, or economic conditions that might be contributing to the higher rates of hate crimes. Understanding these regional influences, it is crucial to address and reduce hate crimes effectively in these areas.

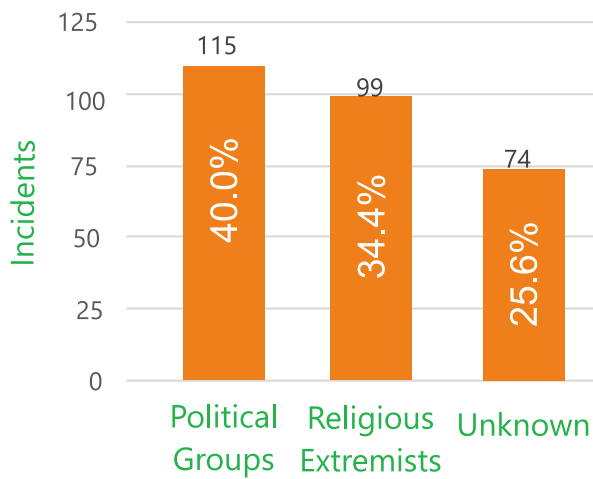
Uttar Pradesh and Maharashtra reported the highest number of incidents, reflecting regional political dynamics and communal tensions that aggravate hate crimes. Uttar Pradesh stands out with the highest number of incidents, totalling 64 cases, which constitutes 22.22% of the overall incidents and Maharashtra is the

second most affected state, with 36 incidents, making up 12.50% of the total.

Rajasthan and Gujarat show notable but comparatively numbers of incidents, with Rajasthan reporting 18 cases (6.25% of the total) and Gujarat 21 cases (7.29%). While these figures are less than those seen in Uttar Pradesh and Maharashtra, they still highlight significant concerns in these states. The presence of hate crimes in both Rajasthan and Gujarat also reveals that these regions, too, face challenges related to intolerance and discrimination.

Other States collectively account for 149 incidents, which is 51.74% of the total. The data shows varying levels of law enforcement effectiveness, including a lack of effective measures in some areas, and differing political commitment to addressing hate crimes across states.

Incident Distribution by Perpetrator Affiliation



Analysis

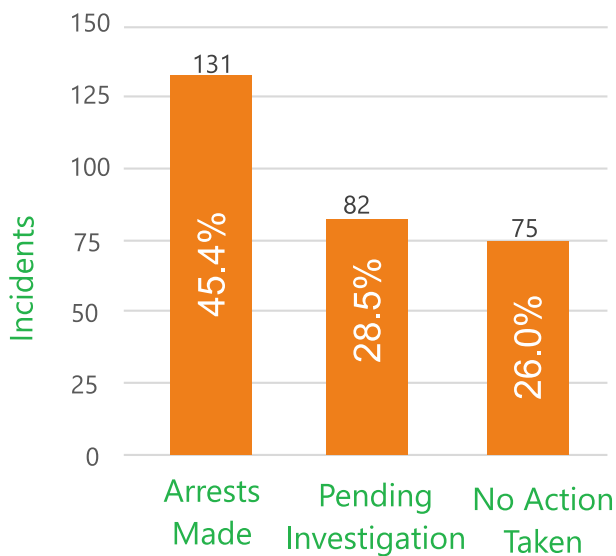
The substantial involvement of political groups and religious extremists in hate crimes reveals the organized and ideologically driven nature of these attacks. At the same time, the high number of unknown perpetrators also brings to light about the difficulties in identifying and prosecuting these offenders.

Political Groups are responsible for 115 incidents, which makes up 40% of the total.

Religious Extremists are linked to 99 incidents, or 34.4% of the total.

Unknown perpetrators account for 74 incidents, representing 25.6% of the total.

Incident Distribution by Legal Status of Incidents



Analysis

The data reveals that nearly half of the incidents have led to arrests, but a significant number are still under investigation or have not seen any legal action. It suggests that we need to make legal processes more efficient to ensure

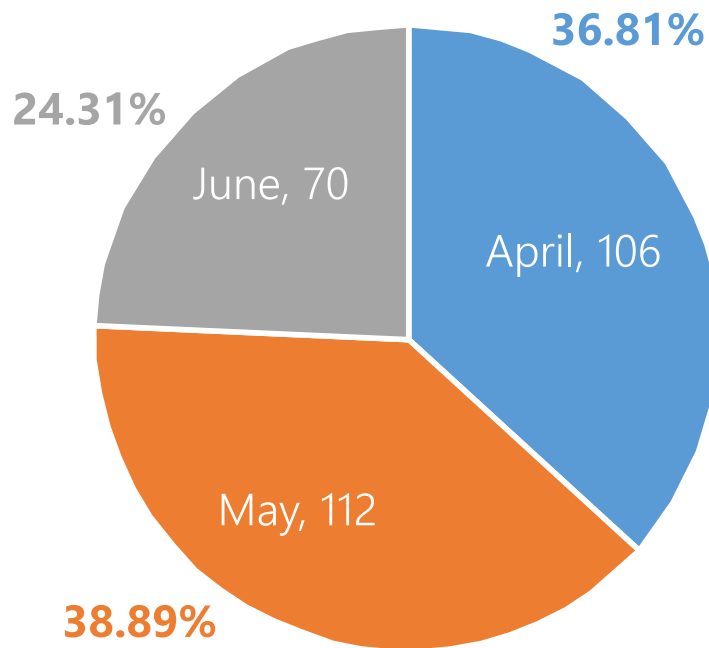
timely and effective resolution of hate crime cases. Additionally, there is a clear need for stronger accountability measures to ensure that perpetrators are held responsible and to prevent future incidents.

There have been arrests in 131 incidents, which accounts for 45.5% of the total. The involvement of political groups in highlights the politicization of communal issues and the role of political rhetoric in inciting hate crimes. Religious extremists' participation in over 1/3rd of the incidents also highlights the influence of radical ideologies in perpetrating violence against minorities.

82 incidents, or 28.5% of the total, are still under investigation. The significant number of incidents with unknown affiliations points to challenges in the identification and prosecution of these perpetrators, often because of insufficient investigative processes.

In 75 incidents, which constitute 26% of the total, no action has been taken. This represents a significant gap in the response to these cases, indicating that a notable portion of incidents remain unresolved and have not yet been addressed through legal or investigative measures.

Monthly Breakdown



Analysis:

The relatively even distribution of incidents across the three months suggests a persistent and ongoing issue. The data from the past three months indicate a troubling trend in the frequency of hate crimes. In April, there were 106 incidents, accounting for 36.81% of the total. May saw a slight increase with 112 incidents, representing 38.89% of the total. June, while showing a decrease, still reported 70 incidents, making up 24.31% of the total. The numbers show a relatively steady rate of incidents each month, indicating that hate crimes are a persistent issue.

April 2024

April 2024 has seen heightened communal tensions and instances of hate speech, deepening divisions within the community. The occurrence of 106 cases highlights the challenges faced by the community regarding violence against minorities and religious discrimination.

Notable Incidents:

- Over 200 booked for offering 'namaz' on road (14 April 2024)

Times of India reported. Around 250 unidentified people were booked by the Uttar Pradesh police in Meerut and Budaun on Friday for allegedly offering 'namaz' on roads during Eid.

- Hindutva mob vandalises Christian school in Telangana, forces principal to say 'Jai Shri Ram' (18 April, 2024)

Scroll reported. A Hindutva mob vandalised a school run by a Christian congregation in Telangana's Mancherla district after the principal told some Hindu students not to wear saffron-coloured clothes to class without permission. The mob assaulted school principal, smeared vermilion on his face and forced him to chant "Jai Shri Ram" as well.

Advocacy & Insights:

The recent booking of over 200 individuals in Meerut and Budaun for offering 'namaz' on public roads highlights an escalating tension between religious practices and public space regulations, pointing to a growing crackdown on religious expressions. Similarly, the assault on a Christian school in Telangana by a Hindutva mob underscores a disturbing rise in religious extremism, with the vandalism of the school and the forced chanting of "Jai Shri Ram" endangering the safety of religious leaders and undermining the principles of religious tolerance and coexistence.

In response to the significant number of incidents reported in April, letters were sent to the Chief Ministers of Bihar, Haryana, Maharashtra, and Uttar Pradesh. These letters highlighted the urgent need for action to address the rising incidents of violence and discrimination. A request was called for a thorough review of the current measures in place, urged the implementation of stronger preventative strategies, and emphasized the importance of enhancing community engagement and for the protection of vulnerable groups.

May 2024

In May, there were concerning trends in communal tensions and attacks on minority communities, particularly targeting Muslims. Instances of hate speech, vigilante violence, and discriminatory practices were reported, with 112 cases documented.

Notable Incidents:

- Muslim Man Assaulted and Falsely Accused Over Bike Incident (24 May 2024)

Indian Patriot Reported. Muslim man brutally beaten by police. Since Arif's bike did not have a number plate, he was asked his name and address, then he was taken to the police station and beaten up all night and a false case was made against him.

- Attack on Vadodara Egg Seller Faizan (2 May 2024)

The Observer Post reported. Mohammed Faizan Amiruddin Shaikh, a street food vendor, was assaulted by three policemen and left paralyzed for life after being dragged by their PCR van. This incident received significant media attention due to the brutality involved and raised concerns over police behavior and accountability.

Advocacy & Insights:

The incidents in May 2024 highlight severe issues with police brutality against minorities. The assault on Arif, a Muslim man, reveals alarming police misconduct and abuse of power over a minor bike issue. Similarly, the attack on street vendor Faizan, which left him paralyzed, underscores the extreme violence and lack of accountability within law enforcement. These incidents underscored issues of communal tensions, police violence, and political rhetoric affecting minority communities in India.

In response to the troubling rise in hate crimes, letters were sent to the Governor of Delhi and the Chief Ministers of Bihar, Gujarat, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, and Uttar Pradesh. These letters urged to take quick action to address the significant number of reported incidents, calling for a thorough review of current measures and the implementation of stronger safeguards to protect minority communities.

June 2024

There were 70 incidents primarily involving communal violence and hate speech against religious minorities. Key issues included attacks on Muslims and their properties, inflammatory speeches by right-wing leaders, and discriminatory actions by authorities. Specific concerns were the misuse of cow protection laws, targeting of religious sites and community leaders, and systemic religious intolerance.

Notable Incidents:

- Mosque Demolitions in Ahmedabad and Bawana (11 June and 21 June 2024)

On 11 June 2024, Times of India reported the demolition of a mosque by the Municipal Corporation in Ahmedabad, Gujarat, alleging the building was unauthorized. On 21 June 2024, Siasat reported mosque was demolished in Delhi's Bawana after a Hindutva leader claimed it was built on government land. Both incidents drew significant media attention, highlighting concerns over religious tensions and property rights.

- Communal Violence and Lynching in Nahan, Himachal Pradesh (19-24 June 2024)

The Print Reported. A series of events in Nahan began with a mob attack on a Muslim man's shop over false allegations of cow slaughter, leading to communal unrest. Investigations revealed that the meat was buffalo, not cow. The continued violence, vandalism, and forced migration of Muslim traders from Nahan were extensively covered in the media, emphasizing the ongoing communal tensions and the impact on the local Muslim community.

Advocacy & Insights:

The insights of these incidents reflects the complex interplay of religious, social, and economic factors in communal conflicts, emphasizing the need for nuanced approaches to conflict resolution and community building.

The correspondence highlights the troubling patterns observed, including the disproportionate targeting of minority communities and the involvement of extremist groups and political entities.

In response to the alarming rise in hate crimes documented during the second quarter of 2024, letters have been sent to the Chief Ministers of Gujarat, Himachal Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Jharkhand, and Uttar Pradesh. These letters address the urgent need for action in light of the significant number of reported incidents in these states.

Conclusion

The second quarter of 2024 has seen a disturbing rise in hate crimes and attacks on minority communities across India. With 288 documented incidents, the level of violence and discrimination has been alarmingly high. The report reveals that Muslims were disproportionately targeted, accounting for nearly 90% of the cases. This significant imbalance points to deep-seated religious intolerance and systemic issues which needs an urgent attention.

The nature of these incidents ranging from hate speech and physical violence to police misconduct and state-sponsored discrimination underlines the severity and sophisticated nature of these issues. The involvement of political groups and religious extremists in many cases reflects an organized, ideological drive behind these attacks. Moreover, the high number of unknown perpetrators points difficulties in identifying and prosecuting the offenders, revealing gaps in both legal and investigative processes. The steady flow of incidents over April, May, and June indicates that the hate crimes are an ongoing problem, not a series of isolated events. The consistent trend calls for a more strong response from all sectors of society.

In light of these findings, it is clear that an immediate and comprehensive action is needed. Justice and Empowerment of Minorities (JEM) is dedicated for advocating the rights of minorities and addressing the changes needed to create an inclusive society.

The second quarter of 2024 has seen a disturbing rise in hate crimes and attacks on minority communities across India.

References & Further Reading

For an in-depth exploration of the incidents reported this quarter, we encourage you to explore into our monthly newsletters. These newsletters represent a collaborative effort, providing not only detailed information of each case.

April 2024 Newsletter

[Click here to view](#)

In April 2024, India has faced a troubling rise in communal violence and hate speech, undermining democratic values and societal unity. From targeted assaults in Uttar Pradesh to child exploitation in Rajasthan, the spread of hate and discord is alarming.

May 2024 Newsletter

[Click here to view](#)

In May 2024, India is grappling with a severe challenge to its democratic values due to a rise in communal violence and hate speech. Disturbing incidents, from targeted attacks in Uttar Pradesh to coercion in Rajasthan, underscore the urgency of addressing this issue.

June 2024 Newsletter

[Click here to view](#)

In June 2024, India is facing rising violence and hate speech that endanger our democracy and unity. Key incidents include false cow meat accusations in Uttar Pradesh and two deaths in Chhattisgarh. Leaders' hate speech and social media misuse are worsening the crisis, compounded by inadequate responses from authorities in Gujarat and Delhi.

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